

IDS11072
Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia

Issued at 3:30 pm CST on Thursday 17 September 2026
for the period until midnight CST Sunday 20 September 2026.

Please be aware

Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A strong high pressure system centred over Victoria will maintain a ridge across SA as it drifts slowly over NSW from Friday. A cold front will then approach from the west late Saturday and move across SA on Sunday, before another ridge pushes in behind the front. The associated high will then move eastwards across waters south from Monday.

Far West Coast: WA-SA Border to Fowlers Bay

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: Easterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots offshore in the evening. Winds turning northeasterly in the late evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots offshore during the morning. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre during the afternoon. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1.5 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning northerly 15 to 25 knots before dawn. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning, then decreasing to 1 metre during the afternoon. Swell: Southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Sunday 20 September

Winds: Southwesterly 15 to 25 knots tending southerly 10 to 15 knots during the evening. Seas: 1 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2.5 metres during the afternoon or evening. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Upper West Coast: Fowlers Bay to Elliston

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: South to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning easterly in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending northerly in the early morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1.5 metres by early evening. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Sunday 20 September

Winds: North to northwesterly 20 to 25 knots shifting south to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots during the day. Seas: 1 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2.5 metres during the evening. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Lower West Coast: Elliston to Cape Carnot

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning north to northwesterly during the morning. Winds reaching up to 20 knots inshore in the late morning and early afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2.5 metres, decreasing to 1.5 metres later in the evening. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres offshore during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Sunday 20 September

Winds: North to northwesterly 20 to 25 knots shifting southwesterly 15 to 20 knots during the afternoon. Seas: 1 to 2 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the afternoon or evening. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Central Coast

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: Northeasterly about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending north to northwesterly during the morning. Winds reaching up to 20 knots in the west in the late morning and afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres in the west around midday. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres in the west. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1.5 metres during the morning. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Sunday 20 September

Winds: North to northwesterly 20 to 25 knots shifting southwesterly 15 to 20 knots during the afternoon. Seas: 1 to 2 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the evening. Weather: Partly cloudy.

South Central Coast

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots turning northwesterly in the late morning. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Northwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning northerly in the late afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1.5 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Sunday 20 September

Winds: North to northwesterly 20 to 25 knots shifting southwesterly 15 to 25 knots during the afternoon.
Seas: 1 to 2 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the afternoon or evening. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Upper South East Coast: Murray Mouth to Cape Jaffa

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: Variable below 10 knots. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning northwesterly during the morning. Winds reaching up to 20 knots offshore in the late evening. Seas: Below 0.5 metres, increasing to around 1 metre during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Northwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning northerly in the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1.5 metres later in the evening. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Sunday 20 September

Winds: North to northwesterly 15 to 25 knots turning west to southwesterly 20 to 25 knots during the day. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2.5 metres during the morning. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Lower South East Coast: Cape Jaffa to SA-VIC Border

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: Northwesterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 0.5 metres, increasing to below 1 metre south of Beachport. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Strong Wind Warning for Friday for Lower South East Coast

Winds: Northwesterly 15 to 20 knots, reaching up to 30 knots south of Beachport in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres south of Beachport around midday. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres, tending westerly 2.5 to 3 metres later in the evening. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Northwesterly 15 to 25 knots turning northerly 15 to 20 knots in the evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1 to 2 metres south of Port MacDonnell. Swell: Westerly 2 to 3 metres, tending southwesterly 2 metres by early evening. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Sunday 20 September

Winds: North to northwesterly 20 to 30 knots turning west to southwesterly during the afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 2 to 2.5 metres during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 3 metres, tending westerly 3 metres during the evening. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots in the early morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming north to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots before dawn. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Sunday 20 September

Winds: Northerly 15 to 25 knots shifting southwesterly 15 to 20 knots during the day. Seas: 1 to 2 metres. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: South to southeasterly about 10 knots becoming east to northeasterly in the late evening. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending north to northwesterly below 10 knots during the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Northerly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Sunday 20 September

Winds: North to northwesterly 15 to 25 knots turning west to southwesterly 15 to 20 knots during the morning. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1 to 2 metres south of Port Vincent to Brighton. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: East to northeasterly below 10 knots. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: West to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres through the Backstairs Passage. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending north to northwesterly in the morning then decreasing to about 10 knots in the evening. Winds reaching up to 20 knots through the Backstairs Passage in the late morning and early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Sunday 20 September

Winds: North to northwesterly 15 to 25 knots shifting southwesterly 15 to 20 knots during the afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres during the morning. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 9:30 pm CST Thursday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.